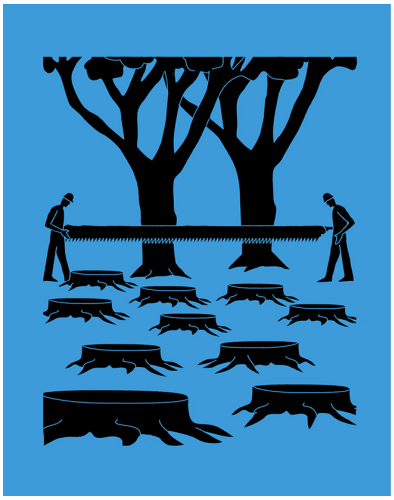


GOD CANNOT SAVE THESE TREES FROM FOOLS

ENDANGERED HABITATS

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

John Muir (1838–1914)

BEFORE

1872 Yellowstone, in the states of Wyoming, Montana, and Idaho, is declared a national park—the first in the world.

AFTER

1948 The International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), a partnership of governments and civil society organizations, is founded.

1961 The World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF), initially known as the World Wildlife Fund, is formed, to protect endangered species and habitats.

1971 The Man and the Biosphere Programme (MAB) is founded by the United Nations, to promote sustainable development. It has a global network of Biosphere Reserves.

The origin of the movement to conserve natural habitats is usually credited to the Scottish–American naturalist John Muir, described as the “father of the national parks.” He was one of the first to realize that in order to survive, wild places needed legal protection. Of the many types of natural